

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam

Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet

'Sewage contamination in CMWSSB's water supply'



Stormwater drain construction site at Pillayar Kovil Street in West Jhafferkhanpet on September 26, 2027; and a bucket of the contaminated water. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

dents have had to clean the sumps.

The ongoing stormwater drain work in Pillayar Kovil Street is the cause for the contamination. Ever since the work began this July, the water got contaminated. We believe during the work, CMWSSB's pipes related to water supply and sewage disposal must have got damaged.

Some of the affected areas are Pillayar Kovil Street, Sapthagiri Colony, Ganga Nagar, Vasudevan Nagar, Thirunagar, and TNHB - Aradhana.

Residents are put to considerable inconvenience. All this points to poor coordination between Greater Chennai Corporation and CMWSSB.

P. Sudhakar is the secretary of Federation of Residential Welfare Associations, West Jhafferkhanpet

P. SUDHAKAR

For the past two months, residents of West Jhafferkhanpet are receiving sewage-contaminated water supplied through the pipes of Chennai Metropolitan Wa-

ter Supply & Sewerage Board.

The colour and odour suggest they are contaminated with sewage. Besides, worms are found. Some residents now buy water from private suppliers including water cans from shops.

From time to time, resi-

Virugambakkam residents flay CMWSSB's 'cavalier attitude'

SATHEESH K

Since February, there is no Metrowater supply to Sindhoori apartment at Venkatesh Nagar Main Road in Virugambakkam. The water pipes of Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board connected to the apartment got damaged during the stormwater drain construction carried out by the Greater Chennai Corporation on Venkatesh Nagar Main Road in February. Seven months have lapsed, but the problem persists. While the water supply was suspended, the payment of water tax was not.

Without Metrowater supply, residents are forced to depend on expensive private water tankers. Complaints have been made to the Assistant Engineers of CMWSSB (Depot 128) and GCC (Ward 128). The officials are asking the residents to bear the expense of restoring the pipes. This is unreasonable. The damage resulted from the negligence of the SWD contractor and residents are in no way responsible for this. It is unfair to expect tax-paying citizens to bear the cost for the fault of the contractor.

Satheesh K is a resident of Virugambakkam

Advertisement

GASTRO ESOPHAGEAL REFLUX DISEASE

• GERD (Gastro esophageal Reflux Disease) is the most common cause of indigestion, affecting up to 30% of the general population.

• GERD affects approximately 14% of the global population. (In Indian population studies, prevalence varies from 5-30%, with a pooled estimate of about 15.6%, and approximately 98.7 million Indians are estimated to have GERD in 2017)

• Reflux esophagitis consists of esophageal mucosal damage resulting from reflux of gastritis or intestinal contents into the esophagus.

• Depending on the causative agent, it is preferred to as peptic, bile, or alkaline esophagitis.

• Occasional episodes of gastro esophageal reflux are common in health. Reflux is followed by esophageal peristalsis waves which efficiently clears the gullet. Alkaline saliva neutralizes residual acid and symptoms do not occur.

• GERD develops when the esophagus mucosa is exposed to gastric contents for prolonged periods of time, resulting in symptoms and/or a proportion of cases to esophagitis. Several factors involved:

• Abnormalities of lower esophageal sphincter, Hiatal hernia, Delayed esophageal clearance, Gastric content, Defective gastric emptying, Increased intra-abdominal pressure, Diet & environmental factors

CLINICAL FEATURES:

• Heartburn.
• Regurgitation
• Bending
• Straining or lying down
• Water brash, Choking as reflux fluid irritates larynx at night, History of weight gain is common, Odynophagia [or] dysphagia is common, Atypical chest pain can mimic angina in few patients.

FACTORS:

• GERD develops through an interaction between increased reflux, reduced anti-reflux barriers, delayed clearance, and reduced mucosal protection. Lifestyle, obesity, pregnancy, hiatal hernia, medications, gastric emptying, and individual susceptibility can all influence the condition.

• GERD is not only a GI disorder. Not only due to hiatus hernia and reduced tone of lower esophageal sphincter.

• It has psycho neuro endocrine mechanism in it.
• Our stress hormones have direct impact over GI system.

Stress hormones:

• cortisol
• epinephrine
• norepinephrine
High levels of stress hormones - change in blood

flow to GIT & slow down digestion, increase stomach acid production, reduce peristaltic movements.

• Poor sleep → poor digestion and vice versa → serotonin is a precursor of melatonin, also known as sleep hormone.

• stress → high cortisol → low serotonin → poor melatonin production → disruption in circadian rhythm (sleep, appetite, digestion, etc.).

• During stress, the sympathetic nervous system is activated, initiating flight-fright response. This physiological reaction prioritizes functions necessary for immediate survival over non-essential activities like digestion.

• Parasympathetic nervous system gets suppressed. Stress alters communication between CNS and enteric nervous system.

HOMOEOPATHIC MANAGEMENT:

In homoeopathy we classify these under 3 stages,

STAGE 1: Patient will have symptoms like

• Burning in the epigastrium, Sour eructation, Heart burn after food, Bloating of abdomen, Difficulties in passing stool

STAGE 2:

• Regurgitations, Frequent excessive eructation, Sleep disturbance, Constipations

STAGE 3:

• Severe regurgitation can also have regurgitation through nose, Bloody regurgitations
• Patient may develop anxiety, Cough
• A detailed food and dietary history should also be obtained; & altered
• Emotional stress, irritability, anxiety associated with the complaints, sleep pattern, should be noted

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‘Unfriendly footpaths and ineffective SWDs on Bazullah Road’

GANESAN GANAPATHI

Plastic wrappers, paper cups, and everyday waste road found scattered or tucked into the corners is a common sight on Bazullah Road in T. Nagar. Beyond being an eyesore, this waste directly washes into storm drain in case of a rain.

The footpaths of Bazullah Road are occupied by construction materials and debris. Whenever a building, residential or commercial, is constructed or undergoes a renovation, piles of sand, gravel, and debris are dumped right on the street and the footpaths. They lie here for weeks. This also enters the stormwater drain.

All these impair the functioning of stormwater drain and result in inundation of the road.

Next, the footpaths of this road are usurped by parking of vehicles. This forces pedestrians to walk on



The footpaths on Bazullah Road in T. Nagar. PHOTOS: VELANKANNI RAJ B

main thoroughfare which witnesses heavy traffic. Shops including eateries encroach upon the space on footpaths. Tables, chairs, dis-

play racks, and vehicles of customers have rendered the footpaths unfriendly to pedestrians.

This also hinders a hassle free

flow of vehicular traffic on the road. It may be noted police patrol the road multiple times a day. But the owners of the illegally parked

vehicles quickly drive off to nearby lanes when the police arrive only to return and park in the same spot within minutes of the police vehicle leaving. Yet another concern is pet poop. It is a sanitary issue. The pet owners do not bother to carry a poop scoop to ensure the dogs do not dirty the road.

Bazullah Road has all the potential to be a shining model street for T. Nagar and the entire city of Chennai. We all dream of living in a neighbourhood that is clean, safe and beautiful. In my view, it can be accomplished with a collective community pride for one's neighbourhood.

The public on their own should respect the rules and regulations that are aimed at safety and cleanliness of the road. When the common space is respected, everyone benefits from a cleaner, safer, and more beautiful neighbourhood.

Ganesan Ganapathi is a resident of Bazullah Road

‘No AC buses for 72 and M27 bus routes’



During the launch of new AC buses on August 25, 2026.
PHOTO: B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

V. JOHAN DHANAKUMAR

Metropolitan Transport Corporation should consider introducing air-conditioned buses for its services – 72 (Thiruverkaadu - T. Nagar) and M27 (Koyambedu - T. Nagar).

MTC added 250 new AC buses this August. However, no buses were dedicated to 72 and M27 routes. It may be noted that both the services witness good patronage.

V. Johan Dhanakumar is a resident of Choolaimedu



‘Water hyacinth invades Porur lake’

C PRABHAKARAN

Porur lake is overrun with water hyacinth. This reduces the water-holding capacity of the lake. The onset of north-east monsoon is round the corner. So, the authorities should clear it at the earliest. Growth of water hyacinths suggest sewage pollution in the lake.

C Prabhakaran is a resident of Porur

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Old Markets, New Trends is a column that features markets that have continued to retain their hold on people's mindscape despite the shifting sands of fads. Through entities that have been around for a long time, it seeks to find out what makes these markets tick

Tarpaulin is just the 'trailer'

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Umbrellas are a victim of "folk association". They are certainly not the sole preserve of the monsoon with its drippy skies, but that is the period they get busier and therefore, get almost entirely associated with the rains. The tarpaulin shops at Nehru Market on Sydenhams Road in Periamet are busy through the year and get a tad busier when the monsoon is round the corner.

But one peek into these tarpaulin shops and there is not a shred of doubt about their all-year relevance. And now, tarpaulin seems like a generic term for a whole range of products that offer a protective cover to valuables. These shops sell those green shade nets for gardens, tents for camping, cotton canvas covers, car covers and bags (which are also covers, glorified covers). These bags are not high-fashion, but made of heavy-duty material and designed to last.

Tarpaulins of various thickness and materials, both determining their prices, are a dominant presence, but one can always shop for more than tarpaulins.

At Nehru Market, there is more to the tarpaulin shops than their name suggests. Their range includes camp tents for the outdoor-oriented and shade nets for those with a green thumb. With the NE monsoon (when they are a tad busier) just weeks away, a look at what helps them cope with changing buyer behaviour



Tarpaulin shops at Nehru Market. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Nehru Market is next door to Anna Market, which is dominated by sale of metal items, many of them massive spare parts that go into the running of industrial machinery. The first few shops at Nehru Market are tarpaulin shops, wholesale and retail, but step in-

side and the shops selling spare parts for industrial machinery predominate. These two markets are not next door neighbours but closer than that, as united as two intercommunicating rooms with a common door. The tarpaulin shops and those selling used spare parts for

industrial machinery exist side by side, by design.

Anil Kumar of Prakash Trading Company points out that these tarpaulin covers are used to cover machinery, among other things. While out here to purchase metal parts for heavy-duty industrial machinery, someone might pick up tarpaulins too. These shops also draw adventurers who like to camp out in a temporary shelter under the skies. Similarly, those with a green thumb. The green shade nets are for them.

Anil Kumar notes that almost every shop, the wholesale shops for certain, would have a tailor attached to it. The tents, shade nets and cotton canvas have to be made to order, often. Promptness is a key factor driving success and survival in this business.

Many of these tarpaulin shops are carryovers from a different era, one pithily defined as "Moore Market". Following the Moore Market fire in the 1980s, traders fanned out depending on where they were allocated a space. That is how some

of the tarpaulin sellers ended up in Nehru Market, managed by Greater Chennai Corporation.

Anil Kumar shoulders the weight of a legacy: the shop was established by his father Narayan Jha over 50 years ago. He worked alongside his father and brother before their deaths, and now the weight of that legacy is entirely on his shoulders. And he finds it to be excruciatingly heavy not only due to the lack of support from a kindred soul, but also market realities. "Counter sales has dwindled," says Anil. "Demand has generally fallen with online shopping changing the way customers buy."

So this is where it stands: much of the regular business comes from factories that use the material to cover machinery, as well as from transporters. Anil qualifies that, saying there is still demand for shade nets, tents, car covers and other items but there is huge competition from various quarters.

The promise of getting items at wholesale rates or even purse-friendly retail rates continues to hold out an attraction for the cost-conscious, and they hit Nehru market. Another shop seller, who does not want to be named, points out that tarpaulins, camping tents and car covers are available at wholesale prices on a section of Walltax Road, largely Ramanan Road and near Elephant Gate Street. But Nehru Market in Sydenhams Road scores on ease of access.

LIFFY THOMAS

More than 11,500 kilos of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing nets, known as ghost nets, were collected in the last three months from the Chennai coast, largely from the Neelankarai-to-Kovalam section. That is just the tip of the iceberg. Tonnes of them are yet to be retrieved from our long coastline, many entangled around marine animals preventing them from moving freely.

“In fact, when the North East Monsoon sets in, the quantity of ghost nets being collected also increases depending on the wind pattern seen during the months of October to March. From December onwards, the ghost nets are observed floating closer to the shore,” says Supraja Dharani, founder of TREE Foundation, a Chennai-based non-governmental organisation that focuses on marine conservation.

Since 2021, the Foundation has been playing a key role in removing tonnes of ghost nets by empowering different stakeholders attached to the seas, the local community and the fishers being their chief ambassadors.

As part of capacity building programmes, they conduct workshops to train fishers in identifying and retrieving a net by steering their boats towards it, looking for marine species in the net, releasing it and pulling the net closer to the boat and bringing it to the shores where it is weighed and sent for recycling.

Tree Foundation currently works in the Chennai-Chengalpattu stretch of the coast, many parts of Andhra Pradesh starting from Sullurpeta, Bapatla, Prakasham, Godavari, Vizianagaram and Srikakulam, southern Odisha and western Goa.

Sea Turtle Protection Force

“Our work in retrieving ghost nets extends to more than 800 km, 285 fishing villages, and 411 fishing



Fishing for ghost nets

Through its Sea Turtle Protection Force, TREE Foundation has built an army of fishers who retrieve ghost nets from the sea



An awareness programme by TREE Foundation for fishermen about ghost nets; and (above) fishermen retrieve abandoned nets.

community members who are part of the Sea Turtle Protection Force; they are the point of contact for fishers of the respective villages,”

says Supraja.

One of the biggest motivations for fishers to retrieve ghost nets is the incentive they receive for the

quantity they collect.

The amount of payment depends on the weight of the net. “Fifty percent of the amount goes to their bank account and the rest to the wife’s or mother’s account, which is used for children’s education, repair of nets and medical emergencies,” says the marine activist.

In the last five years, 217 tonnes of ghost nets have been handed to the TREE Foundation. To further felicitate those who have removed the maximum quantity of ghost nets, a felicitation event is held, usually in the first week of October, where other stakeholders including officers from the Coast Guard and Fisheries department are invited.

“Our success is the result of awareness programmes that we conduct teaching the fisherman how to release entangled endangered marine life including turtles, retrieve the ghost net and hand it over to TREE Foundation. Till date 974 marine megafauna have been released by the fishermen all recorded by videos or photos,” she

says.

The abandoned nets are weighed and sent for recycling. The Foundation has made a pathway at its biodiversity centre in Marakkanam.

Finding corporates willing to support the programme financially is a challenge, and Supraja says they are grateful to be supported by Royal Enfield and AstraZeneca in the ghost net retrieval and incentivisation programme for fishermen along Chengalpattu and Chennai coast.

The weight of these nets range from 100 to 700 kilos and tying it to their boats and bringing it to the shore is not easy.

“We want more corporates to support us in other coastal areas as well. We are soon going to set up a small unit where the nets will be shredded and made into small tiles,” she says. More support from corporates would mean getting more fishermen to join the diving team.

Removing ghost nets entangled in coral reefs will also be an extension of Foundation’s work.

Extending from coast to coast

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

If you are a certified diver then HCL Foundation, the CSR arm of HCL Technologies, should be happy to engage your service to scour the ocean depths for ghost nets. Under HCL Harit, the Foundation has been playing a key role in removing ghost nets.

Started in 2022 from the Chennai coast in Neelankarai, today the initiative extends along the Gulf of Mannar, coasts along Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

As per data, they have successfully mapped, retrieved, and repurposed nearly 4 lakh plus kilograms of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing gear (ALDFG), across several distinct coastal locations in India.

In the Gulf of Mannar, more than 12.9 metric tons of ghost nets have been removed from ecologically sensitive habitats surrounding 21 islands. In Kundapura, Karnataka, they have launched an innovative buy-back model that incentivises fishers to return dis-

carded nets, helping recover over 10,000 kg of ghost gear.

Nidhi Pundhir, vice-president - Global CSR, HCL Tech and Director, HCL Foundation, says they have a MoU with the Ministry of Environment, and over the years they have built a nationwide coalition involving scientific institutions, diving teams, fisher communities, the Indian Coast Guard, coastal police, and grassroot organisations to tackle marine debris.

A dedicated ghost gear man-

agement component was integrated into the Fisher Friend Mobile Application, enabling real time tracking and reporting of ghost gear by fishing communities.

Nidhi says there is a whole process involved in recycling the ghost nets that serves as a supplementary income for communities. “When we get these nets, they have a whole lot of salt coating on it and is not easily recyclable. We are doing a lot of R&D including converting them into nets which are used for various sports activities, designing bags and for other creative use,” says Nidhi.

To engage university students

to design upcycled, functional products from the retrieved nylons, the Foundation conducted the Ghost Net Innovation Challenge. Recently, on International Coastal Cleanup Day, the Foundation organised a mega cleanup campaign of oceans, involving volunteer and community members.

“From CSR design point of view, we have been thinking that we really need to take a district-level kind of an approach in certain places where we have higher employee strength. And we have been looking at a “convergence model” as our next step,” says Nidhi.

At Mudichur, birders chanced upon a Java sparrow while having gone there in the hope of seeing another bird species. The Java sparrow is a breeding resident in parts of Indonesia. And this particular individual is likely a captive bird that had slipped out of a cage, raising questions about the sordid side of the pet trade

PRINCE FREDERICK

The backdrop can sometimes cast a sombre shadow over a stage pulsating with a grand achievement. Knowing the backstory can automatically signal restraint, cutting out celebration, even justified celebration, without a twinge of regret. An extensively reported event this year would make this idea clearer. Royal Challengers Bangalore cut out the victory parade following their triumph in IPL 2026 clearly because the “backdrop” of a tragic stampede the previous year loomed large casting a long shadow over a merry moment that played out on a grand stage. Something parallel to that, sans the sombreness, happened recently in the Chennai Metropolitan Area.

Over a week’s duration, the start date being September 19, Mudichur in Tambaram witnessed a parade of birders out to catch a glimpse of a rare avian, so rare that when news of its sighting hit their “auriculars”, some dropped their telephoto zoom lens. It was a Java sparrow (*Padda oryzivora*) found in parts of Indonesia, Java being one of them, where they are meant to be found. The sad story (actually, the backstory birders out here were aware of) is that this bird is also found where it has no business poking its beak around, and it is not to be blamed for that. Aviculture and, in a larger sense, human beings’ innate ability honed by greed to interfere with Nature’s delicate but sound systems. The birders sensed this bird could have slipped past the open shutter of some cage



Java sparrow and (above) European roller at Mudichur on September 19. PHOTOS: JITHESH BABU

here, and that knowledge tempered the sense of having found something rare. They clicked away still, but there was restraint in their posts about the sighting.

Birders Jithesh Babu and Saravanan Manian had discovered the Java sparrow in Mudichur serendipitously while seeking to pay another bird a visit, a passage migrant in Chennai.

“On September 19, we were there looking for the European roller, which was reported to have been sighted at Mudichur,” says Jithesh. The European roller (*Coracias garulus*) not showing up immediately, the birders ventured a little further in than they had expected to, and

there it was, a surprise in a package of red, pink, grey, black and white: a Java sparrow with, probably until recently, a local address on its calling card.

If the European roller had a sense of humour and the power of speech to express it, it surely would have rasped out “and you thought I was the surprise!” The European roller breeds in Europe and winters in Africa and is known to ink in Chennai as a pit stop on its iconic long-distance migration, almost treated as a sub category in migration, being dubbed “roller migration”. Last year, European roller sighting was reported from the Broken Bridge area of the Adyar Estuary.

VELS University honours 1,000 school teachers



VELS University organised the VELS Teachers Excellence Awards 2026 across its various campuses. As part of the Teachers' Day celebrations, the felicitation ceremony was held at the VELS University campus in Pallavaram. Premalatha Vijayakant, MLA, Virudhachalam Constituency and general secretary, DMDK, graced the occasion as chief guest and felicitated the teachers, says a press release.

Preethaa Ganesh, vice president, VELS University, said that "teaching is the finest profession, as it creates and shapes all other professions."

Premalatha Vijayakant recalled the teacher who had a significant influence on her during her school years. She said: "Teachers carry the great responsibility of guiding students on the right path. Captain



▼ Premalatha Vijayakant with the awardees

own life as well. A teacher named Loganathan guided me and played an important role in shaping me into the person I am today. Though he is no longer with us, I will always remember and acknowledge his contribution to all my achievements."

The VELS Teachers Excellence Awards 2026 have been instituted to recognise and honour the dedicated service of teachers who play a significant role in shaping students' knowledge, skills, character and future, says the press release.

The event was attended by Arthi Ganesh, pro chancellor, VELS University; M. Baskaran, vice chancellor; M. Chandrasekaran, registrar, and other senior members of the university administration.

Vijayakant deeply understood the importance of education and extended educational assistance to thousands of students to help them continue their studies. Behind the success of every student, there is the contribution of a teacher who guided and encouraged them. There was such a teacher in my

K Mohandas Memorial Award for former Tamil Nadu DGP



K Ramanujam, former Director General of Police, Tamil Nadu, receives the award.

B Force, a charitable trust based in Chennai, operating with the aim of providing and facilitating the Tamil Nadu Police force and their families with medical assistance, specifically in the areas of management of cancer, was launched as a tribute to K. Mohandas IPS, former Director General of Police, Tamil Nadu and his wife, Santha Mohandas. K. Mohandas belonged to the 1956 batch of the Indian Police Service, Tamil Nadu cadre. The trust was established by the four daughters of the Mohandas couple.

A press release from B Force points out that to commemorate

its anniversary, B Force bestows an award instituted as "The K Mohandas Memorial Award". This award is conferred upon a past senior police officer who has contributed to the police force beyond the call of his duty.

This year, on September 22, 2026, to commemorate its 19th anniversary, B Force conducted an awards ceremony at Amir Mahal. Recipient of the prestigious award is K Ramanujam IPS, former Director General of Police, Tamil Nadu. As chief guest, Nawabzada Mohammed Asif Ali, Dewan to the Prince of Arcot presented and felicitated the decorated officer with the award.

135 school teachers in the limelight at Guru Dhakshina 2026



Agurchand Manmull Jain College, recently hosted its much-anticipated annual ceremony, Guru Dhakshina 2026, a celebration of gratitude recognising teachers at the Bhagwan Mahaveer Gyan Bhavan.

The college paid tribute to 135 school teachers, chosen from across schools in and around Chennai, says a press release. The ceremony was graced by an eminent panel of guests and dignitaries. Film actor, motivational speaker and

educationist Dhamu was chief guest. Founder of Farmguru Agritech was the guest of honour.

The event was also attended by Ushan Kumar Chordia, secretary; Hemant P. Chordia, associate secretary; N. Venkataramanan, director; M.M. Ramya, dean; and R. Surekha, deputy dean.

The ceremony featured a symbolic gesture of a student seeking blessings from a teacher, capturing the Guru-Shishya tradition.

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A photo contest for the deaf

The last date for submission of entries is September 30. The theme of the contest is nature conservation and the winners will be honoured during Wildlife Week 2026 in October

Rotary club of Chennai Crown and Madras photobloggers are organising an exclusive photo contest for the deaf on nature conservation, as part of International Week of Deaf Awareness.

The link for submission is <http://tinyurl.com/YAAVARUM-PHOTO-CONTEST>. The last date for submission is September.

Winners of the contest will be honoured during Wildlife Week 2026 in October.



Earlier, on September 20, also as part of the International Week of Deaf Awareness, a nature photo walk was organised at Nanmangalam reserve forest exclusively for the deaf community, with interpreter support, through a collaborative effort of Care Earth Trust, Tamil Nadu Forest Department, Madras Photobloggers, and Rotary Club of Chennai Crown.

Thirty-five deaf participants ac-

tively took part in the photowalk. Officials from Care Earth Trust and the Tamil Nadu Forest Department introduced participants to the rich diversity of flora and fauna, helping them observe and appreciate the natural environment around them.

Rotary club of Chennai Crown and Madras photobloggers helped the participants in documenting nature, says a press release

Participants captured their experiences through mobile phones and cameras, exploring nature through their own perspectives and creativity. The programme provided an inclusive space for the deaf community to connect with nature, learn about biodiversity, and express themselves through photography and the upcoming photocontest exclusively for the deaf.

City ophthalmologist honoured at conference in Bangkok

Ophthalmologist from Chennai Dr D P Prakash was invited to give a keynote speech on eye care at the United Nations Conference Centre in Bangkok on September 25. The summit was on sustainable living and wellbeing, says a press release.

His presentation was titled "The World- First Artificial Intelligence Based Vision Care System."

In his address, the chief eye surgeon of American Eye Care Centre highlighted how India is losing a gross national income of 646 billion rupees due to the 70 million vision-impaired population apart from the 4.9 million blind people, says a press release.

He spoke a proprietary Agentic AI Technology known as "The Seranova" which would integrate every aspect of the vision testing process right from history to diagnosis and eye wear selection and referral, adds the press release.

The AI also generates what he calls "The Prakash Perfect Vision Score" that enables the patient to understand if his eyes are normal or not, says the press release.

Delegates from various member countries and dignitaries from WHO, Red Cross International and ambassadors to Thailand from Mo-



rocco, Nepal South Africa, Russia, and Hungary took part.

On the occasion, he received the Global Change Maker Award for his contribution towards advancing eye care and sustainable health care development from Dr . Giovanni Jing, UNESCO, Italy.

Season two of Battle of Brains

Battle of Brains, an inter-school quiz, is back with its second season. Organised by Casagrand, in association with Nexus Consulting, schools across Chennai can register teams of two students from classes 6 to 10 at no cost. Registrations are open until October 5, 2026.

The event will be held from October 10 to November 15, 2026.

The winning teams from the zonal rounds will advance to the city final, where they will compete for the Battle of Brains Season 2 title.

The second season will also extend the quizzing experience beyond students with a dedicated parents and teachers quiz.

The first season saw enthusiastic participation from over 250 schools across Chennai. Sachin Sathyasivan and Perri Karthik Chi-



dambaram from B. V. Bhavan's Rajaji Vidhyashram School were crowned the champions of Casagrand's Battle of Brains 2025, winning exciting prizes worth ₹4 lakh along with the prestigious trophy, said a release.

Inter-school oratorical competition

Union Christian Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Chetpet will be conducting the second edition of its inter-school oratorical competition, Oratoria'26, for students of classes VII to XII on October 29 and 30. The

event would also feature a debate segment with an overall prize package worth ₹90,000 including a return ticket to an exotic destination, said a release. Scan the QR code to register. Contact: 73051 75551/97892 91683

Eye camp

TwinTech Healthcare Services is organizing an eye camp for elders aged 70 and above on October 1 and October 15 at Kalpaviruksha Centre, 3, Nagarathinammal Colony, (near Adhi Kesava Perumal Temple) West Mambalam. According to press release, no fee will be charged. Prior appointment is essential for which a WhatsApp message should be sent to the number 97104 85295 between 10 a.m. and 5 p.m. on or before September 28.

The message should have the following details: name, age, and preferred date of examination, adds the release.

Yoga classes

Satyananda Yoga Centre is conducting a four-week Yoga programme in K.K. Nagar, Nanganallur, Velachery, Mambakkam, Madambakkam, and Mylapore from September 27. According to a press release, no fee will be charged. The centre follows the curriculum of Bihar School of Yoga. Time: From 5.30 a.m. to 7 a.m. Mantra recitation, sessions on value education and food habits are part of the programme. For venue details, call 6383008358 / 8754499334 / 9841227709 / 9176902929